

CSCE 46103/56103 Artificial Intelligence – Fall 2026

Course Orientation

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Today's Topics

1. **Course Orientation:** people, logistics, and the semester plan
2. **AI Today:** what the field includes in 2026

People

Instructor

Jungtaek Kim

`jukim@uark.edu`

`jungtaekkim.github.io`

Office hour: Tuesday 5:00 PM–6:00 PM

Teaching Assistant

Mariha Siddika Ahmad

`ma135@uark.edu`

Office hour: Thursday 5:00 PM–6:00 PM

Logistics

Classroom

BELL 2286

Tuesday 3:30 PM–4:45 PM

Instructor office hour: 5:00 PM–6:00 PM

Thursday 3:30 PM–4:45 PM

TA office hour: 5:00 PM–6:00 PM

Course Website

<https://jungtaek.github.io/courses/2026-fall-artificial-intelligence>

Prerequisites

CSCE 46103

CSCE 31903, CSCE 319H3, or DASC 21003, each with a grade of C or better.

CSCE 56103

Graduate standing in the CSCE Department.

If you are unsure whether your preparation is a good match, please talk with me early. I will help you identify any background to review.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this course, you should be able to:

- ▶ formulate AI problems using appropriate states, actions, representations, uncertainty, and objectives;
- ▶ select, implement, and compare methods for search, inference, decision making, and learning;
- ▶ evaluate AI systems using evidence, including assumptions, limitations, and failure modes; and
- ▶ explain and defend design choices while using AI coding tools transparently and verifying their outputs.

Attendance and Updates

- ▶ Attendance is not a separate graded component, but regular attendance supports learning in this course.
- ▶ If you must miss class or a situation affects an assessment, please contact me as soon as practical. I will discuss appropriate next steps within university and course policies.
- ▶ Material course changes will be announced clearly and as early as practical. Cancellations and continuity instructions will be sent through the official course channel.

Course Roadmap

Period	Main focus
Aug.–early Sep.	Agents, problem formulation, search, games, and constraints
Sep.–early Oct.	Probability, Bayesian networks, and sequential decisions
Oct. 15–22	Midterm exam, fall break, and feedback
Late Oct.–Nov.	Machine learning, neural networks, reinforcement learning, Transformers, and foundation-model systems
Dec.	Responsible AI, security, and final preparation

Grading

Component	Weight
Assignments	50%
Midterm Exam	20%
Final Exam	30%

Assignments

	Released	Due	Review
Assignment 1	Aug. 27	Sep. 10	Sep. 17
Assignment 2	Sep. 10	Sep. 24	Oct. 1
Assignment 3	Sep. 24	Oct. 8	Oct. 13
Assignment 4	Oct. 27	Nov. 10	Nov. 17
Assignment 5	Nov. 12	Nov. 24	Dec. 1

- ▶ Submit assignments through Blackboard (learn.uark.edu).
- ▶ Python is recommended for assignments.
- ▶ Assignment topics will be announced with their specifications.

Document Format

- ▶ Write each assignment report in $\text{\LaTeX}$.
- ▶ Use the official NeurIPS 2026 formatting package.
- ▶ Do not change the template's fonts, margins, or spacing.
- ▶ Follow the report length and required sections in each assignment specification.

Late Days

- ▶ Each student has five late days for the semester.
- ▶ At most three late days may be used on one assignment.
- ▶ Late days may not be used for the Midterm Exam or Final Exam.

AI Coding Tool Policy

Allowed

AI coding tools are allowed in this course.

Required submission

Submit all reasonably available, user-visible AI-use records, including unsuccessful or discarded sessions when exportable. Add `AI_USE.md` with the tool/model, purpose, materially influenced files, and explanations for unavailable records.

For a coding harness or agent, include available action or command logs and verification results. Use Git history and the final diff as the file-change record; prompt-to-line and keystroke-level records are not required.

If you used no AI coding tool, submit: **I did not use an AI coding tool for this assignment.**

You remain responsible for testing, understanding, and explaining all submitted work.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity protects the trust that makes learning together possible.

- ▶ Follow each assignment's collaboration rules.
- ▶ Submit work that you understand, and acknowledge sources, collaborators, and permitted AI assistance.
- ▶ AI coding tools are allowed under the documentation requirements described in this course.
- ▶ If an expectation is unclear, please ask before submitting. I am happy to clarify.

Key Dates

Date	Event
Oct. 8	Midterm Exam Preparation
Oct. 15	Midterm Exam
Oct. 20	No class—Fall Break
Oct. 22	Midterm Solutions and Feedback Review
Nov. 26	No class—Thanksgiving Holiday
Dec. 3	Final Exam Preparation
Dec. 8	Final Exam, 3:00 PM–5:00 PM

Textbook

Textbook

Russell and Norvig [2020], *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*, 4th edition.

- The schedule identifies the reading associated with each class.

Access and Accommodations

Your experience in this class is important to me.

- ▶ If you have approved disability accommodations, please request your CEA letter early and contact me privately so I have time to arrange them.
- ▶ If you have not yet established accommodations, the Center for Educational Access can help.
- ▶ You do not need to disclose the nature of your disability to the instructor.

Center for Educational Access

cea.uark.edu ada@uark.edu 479-575-3104

Student Well-Being

Your well-being matters. If personal circumstances are affecting your learning, you are welcome to contact me early. I will listen, discuss course-related options, and help connect you with support.

- ▶ **CAPS:** counseling and 24-hour emergency mental-health support at 479-575-5276.
- ▶ **U of A Cares:** non-emergency referrals and support when circumstances interfere with a student's success.
- ▶ For immediate danger, call 911.

Thank You

Any questions?

References

S. J. Russell and P. Norvig. *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*. Pearson, 4th edition, 2020.